A-A-53444
29 April 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SLING, HEAD

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description covers a universal size traction halter suitable for vertical and horizontal cervical traction.

Salient characteristics:

The head sling shall consist of a chin pad and occipital pad connected by two adjustable webbing straps, one on each side of the head, suitable for vertical and horizontal cervical traction.

The chin pad shall be kidney shaped and shall measure approximately 3-5/8 inches by 6-1/2 inches. The occipital pad shall be dog-bone in shape and shall measure approximately 4-1/8 inches by 15-1/4 inches. Both pad outer covers shall be made of a washable type brown cotton duck lined with soft flannel interior pieces that contact the body. Both pads shall have an interior layer of 1/4 inch thick foam cushioning for patient comfort. The edges of the pads shall be closed with a 3/4 inch wide tape binding suitably stitched with thread. All stitching shall have between 6 and 10 stitches per inch.

All of the webbing straps used with the head sling shall be cotton or nylon, the same approximate color as the cotton duck pad exterior covers, one inch nominal in width. All exposed ends shall be treated to prevent raveling. Two approximately 12-1/2 inch long webbing straps shall have "D" rings attached to their distal ends, and the other ends shall be sewn to the occipital pad, one at each side. These straps shall adequately clear the top of the skull, and shall accept an orthopedic style spreader bar.

AMSC N/A FSC 6530

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The chin pad shall be shaped by forming three gathers in one side of the duck cover. The occipital pad shall have the two straps with the "D" rings attached at the distal end caught under the binding stitching. The other ends of the straps shall be turned around the "D" ring for 1-1/4 inches and shall be sewn with three rows of stitching. The straps shall also be sewn to the exterior cover at the area where they overhang the pad, with one row of stitching.

At the approximate midpoint of their occipital pad overlap, the 12 1/2 inch long "D" ring straps shall have three-inch long straps, doubled, with the ends touching, sewn underneath, using two rows of stitching, reinforced with cross stitching. One three inch doubled strap shall support an adjustable buckle, and the other an end clip, located to secure an adjustable buckle, mounted on the end of a strap secured to the chin pad. The portion of the straps that overlap the exterior cover shall be sewn on both edges for the overlapping length.

The exterior cover of the chin pad shall have an approximately nine-inch strap mounted on each side, with three rows stitching, reinforced with cross stitching. The distal end of one of these straps shall be secured with the adjustable buckle mounted on one side of the occipital pad. The distal end of the other strap shall be fitted with an adjustable buckle retained by turning the end of the straps under 3/8 inch and stitching with three rows of stitches. This buckle shall hook on the end clip, mounted on the other end of the occipital pad. The adjustable buckles will provide the strap adjustment needed to adjust the head sling to the patient.

The metal adjustable buckles, end clips, and "D" rings shall be fabricated of a suitable corrosion-resisting steel, properly tempered and passivated.

All head sling stitching shall be free from defects. Thread breaks, skip, and run-off shall be overstitched not less than one-half inch. Skipped stitches, or thread breaks, shall be repaired. The thread tension shall be maintained so that there shall not be any loose or tight stitching, and the lock shall be embedded in the materials being sewn together. All thread ends shall be trimmed to a maximum length of one quarter of an inch.

The head sling shall support a minimum weight of 75 pounds, spread uniformly over the area between the stitching of the pad, without any visible evidence of damage.

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The design of the head sling shall prevent pressure on the neck, carotid artery, or nerves.

The head sling shall not contain any stains, spots, non-specified holes, abraded areas, tears, cuts, mends, patches, scorches, or needle chews.

The head sling shall not have an objectionable odor.

Workmanship. The head sling shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One sling, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

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Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 1.0 (percent defective) and an inspection level of II. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one head sling as specified in this description.

Defects.

Any component missing, improperly assembled, or not as specified.

Metal parts not fabricated of a suitable corrosion-resisting steel.

Open seam, thread breaks, skip or run-off not overstitched at least one-half inch.

Loose or tight stitching.

Objectionable odor.

Thread ends trimmed as specified.

Metal parts not free of burrs or sharpness.

Abrasion marks on pads or webbing.

Stitching not uniformly gauged.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests including dimensional test, shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 2.5 (percent defective) and inspection level of S-3. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one head sling.

Tests

Test for Fit. One head sling shall be placed on an individual's head. After adjustment of the straps, the head sling shall be examined for fit and compliance with the requirement to accept an orthopedic style spreader bar at the "D" rings.

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Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

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Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6530-1986

PGC 51364

Location: CID/SLING/H13-30

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions - Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53444	SLING, HEAD

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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